

Ten Commandments to Safeguard Your Bank Account



Dinu Vincent is an electronics and communication engineering graduate, currently working in the security operation centre of a leading private sector bank in India. He is a certified ethical hacker and holds a computer hacking forensic investigator certification

Ever since Adam and Eve sinned in the Garden of Eden, God's desire has been to restore the broken relationship between God and people. God made a covenant, which is a promise from God that can never be broken. The covenant states that God wants a relationship with the people, but in order to have this loving relationship, they have to turn away from their sin. This can also be interpreted as the act of avoiding mistakes. So if we avoid mistakes, the relationship will exist forever and we will live in prosperity.

In this digital age, money transfer is a matter of a few clicks. With this advantage, there are drawbacks that allow an innocent user to be tricked easily by a fraudster, thus resulting in easy money for the culprit. The few tips explained in this article will help you to stay alert against such practices, and stay in a good relationship with your bank.

Validate the URL

Manoj is an employee working in an information technology (IT) company and his salary account is with HOPE bank. He has to transfer some money to his friend. So he accesses

the bank's Internet banking website. Since he frequently uses this facility, he feels something odd about the portal. He identifies that the uniform resource locator (URL) address is www.internetbanking.h0pebank.com instead of www.internetbanking.hopebank.com (0 instead of o).

Phishing websites are hoax websites that have the look and feel of a legitimate website. Hackers create phishing websites to collect information such as Internet banking credentials, card details, automated teller machine (ATM) pin numbers and personal details, so that they can make use of these to pilfer money from the victim's bank account.

Pharming is the technique to redirect traffic from a legitimate website to a fraudulent one by making use of the former's vulnerabilities in the DNS server, or by modifying the host file of the victim's PC. Web pages used for pharming attacks are the same as that of the genuine website, which makes it difficult to spot the difference.

One good way to get away from these fraudulent websites is to validate their URLs. Nowadays, almost all banking websites and Internet banking portals have EVSSL certificates. Have you ever noticed your browser's address bar turning to green colour while accessing your bank's website? This denotes that the URL is verified by a certificate authority (approved). Phishing sites will lack these certifications.

Enable second-factor authentication

The most practical way to strengthen authentication is to necessitate a second factor after the username/password stage. Since a password is something that a user knows, ensure that the user also has something that thwarts attackers who steal or gain access to passwords.

Traditional two-factor authentication (TFA) solutions use hardware tokens that

